

Assessment cover (Individual Submission)

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Module No:	COMP4035	Module title:	Computer Science Applications
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Assessment number:	Part 1	Assessment title:	Reflections on creating a Project Proposal <i>Individual Submission</i>
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Banner assignment identifier	CWS1WEEK06	Due date and time:	Friday 31 October 2025 13:00
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Estimated total time to be spent on assignment:	XXX hours per student
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LEARNING OUTCOMES

On successful completion of this assignment, students will be able to achieve the following learning outcomes (LOs):
LO 1: Demonstrate an understanding of business processes and modern work practices including group work, show basic analytic reflection of these processes, and be able to document them.

STUDENT NAMES

Student No:	Student ID Number (Only):	Group Name and Number:
1.	19311715	Set 3, Group 33
2.		
3.		
4.		
5.		

Statement of Compliance

By submitting this assessment I declare that the work submitted is my own and that the work I submit is fully in accordance with the University regulations regarding assessments.

www.brookes.ac.uk/uniregulations/current

Use of AI Tools: You are required to use this [form](#) to declare which AI tools you have used and how you have used them. Please complete the form and attach it to your submission as an Appendix, if you have used such tools.

FORMATIVE FEEDBACK OPPORTUNITIES

Help will be available at weekly practical sessions.

SUMMATIVE FEEDBACK DELIVERABLES

Deliverable content and standard description and criteria	Weighting out of 100%
See coursework specification	

RUBRIC

		Not attempted 0	Fail 1	Pass 2	Good Pass 3	High Pass 4	Excellent 5	Full marks
Group Contribution (1 from the following; 0 for part not done by this group member)								
Analysis of the Domain	5	No attempt or an answer that doesn't address the question asked.	An analysis has been provided but it either doesn't cover all significant areas or shows little understanding of them or is incorrect.	The analysis does explain what the system will do and describes what the website will sell and provides the larger company context but without any detail.	The analysis does explain what the system will do and describes what the website will sell and provides the larger company context but only one of these is explained well.	The analysis does explain what the system will do and describes what the website will sell and provides the larger company context but only two of these is explained well.	The analysis does explain what the system will do and describes what the website will sell and provides the larger company context with all three of these being explained well.	The analysis is very good and shows a lot of thought has gone into what the system will comprise of.
Description of the system development process	5	No attempt or an answer that doesn't address the question asked.	Either no methodology is given, there is no justification or both of these are provided but there is little said about them.	A sensible methodology has been chosen and there is a reasonable justification for it.	A sensible methodology has been chosen and there is a reasonable justification for it.	The methodology choice is good and the justification makes a strong case for it.	The methodology choice is good and a strong justification that shows a good understanding of the problem and the methodology is given.	The methodology choice is good and a strong justification that shows an excellent understanding of the problem and the methodology is given.
Description of the system capabilities	5	No attempt or an answer that doesn't address the question asked.	Either the functional requirements or user stories provided are poor or the choice doesn't work for the chosen methodology.	The choice of functional requirements or user stories is correct and a reasonable attempt has been made at describing what is needed.	The functional requirements/user stories provided are the correct choice and cover the functionality effectively.	The functional requirements/user stories provided are the correct choice and cover the functionality very well.	The functional requirements/user stories provided are the correct choice, cover all the required functionality and show that some thought has gone into making an effective system.	The functional requirements/user stories provided are the correct choice, cover all the required functionality and display a very strong understanding of what the system will need.

Evaluation of social, legal and ethical issues that are relevant to the proposed website	5	No attempt or an answer that doesn't address the question asked.	Some relevant issues have been covered but there is little here.	Some attempt has been made to address social, legal and ethical issues.	Social, legal and ethical issues have been addressed and one of these has been evaluated well.	Social, legal and ethical issues have been addressed and two of these has been evaluated well.	Social, legal and ethical issues have been addressed and all three have been evaluated well.	Social, legal and ethical issues have been addressed and the responses for all three show a good understanding of the issues as applied to this project.
Testing	5	No attempt or an answer that doesn't address the question asked.	Either a poor testing strategy has been described or there is a poor justification or one of the two is missing.	A sensible testing strategy has been described and there is some justification of it.	A sensible testing strategy has been described and there is a good justification of it.	A sensible testing strategy has been described and there is a very good justification of it.	A sensible testing strategy has been described and there is an excellent justification of it.	A sensible testing strategy has been described and there is an excellent justification of it showing a good understanding of the issues involved.
Individual Report (All of the following)								
Describe your role in the team i: how well did the team work together? ii: what went well and what did not and why? lii: what lessons do you take from this group work for future group projects?	5	No attempt or an answer that doesn't address the question asked.	An attempt has been made at describing what happened but one or more of the following have not been addressed: how well the team functioned, what went well and what went badly, any lessons learned.	How well the team worked together has been described. What went well and what did not have been described. Lessons that could be taken from how the group functioned have been described. The answers show little evidence of having thought about the implications though.	How well the team worked together has been described. What went well and what did not have been described. Lessons that could be taken from how the group functioned have been described. The answer to one of these goes beyond simple description with some reflection included.	How well the team worked together has been described. What went well and what did not have been described. Lessons that could be taken from how the group functioned have been described. The answer to two of these goes beyond simple description with some reflection included.	How well the team worked together has been described. What went well and what did not have been described. Lessons that could be taken from how the group functioned have been described. The answer to all three of these goes beyond simple description with some reflection included.	Each of the answers to the three subparts is thoughtful and well explained showing a good understanding of what has been learned.
Describe what you consider to be your strengths and weaknesses within the group based on your contribution	5	No attempt or an answer that doesn't address the question asked.	Strengths and weaknesses have been described but at least one of the two have not been described in terms that can sensibly be related to the work done.	Strengths and weaknesses have been addressed and the answers given make sense in the context of the work carried out.	The description of the strengths and weaknesses show some thought has gone into relating them contextually to the work effectively.	The description of the strengths and weaknesses show that they have been effectively assessed and related well to the work carried out.	The strengths and weaknesses displayed have been very well described and their justification based on the work done is strong.	The descriptions of the strengths and weaknesses have been well thought through and show a very good understanding of the implications of what has been found.

Describe any particular challenges that came up in working in the group and explain how you overcame or mitigated them.	3	No attempt or an answer that doesn't address the question asked.	Little has been described here or there are is no discussion of how issues were overcome or mitigated.	Some sensible challenges have been described but there is little in the way of discussion of how they were overcome or mitigated.	A generally sensible answer but either there are very few challenges or they are not well described, or the discussion of how they were overcome or mitigated lacks depth.	The challenges are well described showing some understanding of why they caused problems and the explanation of overcoming them or mitigation strategies described are sensible and well explained	The challenges are well explained with a good understanding of their implications for the project and the well described mitigation strategies show that responses to the challenges were well thought through.	Challenges are very well explained with a strong understanding of how they affected the project and the mitigation strategies show that a lot of thought has gone into how best to effectively mitigate the challenges.
What lessons do you take away from this group work for future group projects?	3	No attempt or an answer that doesn't address the question asked.	There is some attempt at answering the question but there is little here or what has been provided doesn't make sense in the context of how the project went.	The lessons learned are sensible.	Lessons learned are sensible and clearly relate to how the project went.	Lessons learned are sensible, relate to how the project went and show an understanding of personal strengths and weaknesses as displayed in the project.	Lessons learned are well described and show that there has been some thought into how to work more effectively in groups in future.	Lessons learned are well described and show that a lot of thought has gone into how the project went and what was effective and how what didn't go well could be improved on.
Documenting the groupwork process	3	No attempt or an answer that doesn't address the question asked.	An incomplete set of notes has been submitted.	A set of notes for each of the meetings has been submitted but there is little content in each note.	Notes with agendas have been submitted for all meetings and there is evidence of the agenda having been followed	Notes with agendas have been submitted and actions have been assigned to group members	Notes with agendas have been submitted. Actions have been assigned to group members and progress on actions has been recorded.	The notes are clear, concise and well described with agendas actions assigned, progress on actions and sensible responses to the progress reports.

Introduction: Theory into Practice

This report is a personal reflection on the group project for the COMP4035 module. My goal is to assess my performance, our collaboration as a team, and what I learned about project management. After discussing various agile approaches, including the risk-focused Spiral model, our group made a strategic decision to adopt the Scrum framework for its iterative and adaptive structure. We used Discord for our online communication, additionally in-person meetings during our practical's. This approach was something I was responsible for justifying in my part of the report. I argued that this would make us flexible and effective. While the framework itself was adaptive, my own understanding of its practical application was incomplete. While it was challenging it taught me far valuable experience than expected. This reflection is an honest account of the gap between the well-laid plans and the complicated adaptation to working cooperatively.¹

The Role and Its responsibilities

The contribution to the project began before roles were formally assigned, by initially contacting and emailing the group to schedule our starting meetings. This helped get the project going. While every section was equally crucial for the project, “system-development process” came with responsibilities of creating a framework that would connect the other sections. It was important to propose adaptive methodologies for members working on “System Capabilities” and “Testing. A concern was proposing a model that theoretically laid out a structured plan but behaved impractical through writing. To lower risks the ideas were discussed with the team early on to take on early feedback in our roles and simply ensuring a clear final report.

A significant challenge was the strict 500-word limit. Compressing weeks of lectures and research through learned knowledge into a considerable small format was difficult. Another challenge was justifying the use of Discord. While the team understood its practical benefits for rapid communication, framing a less formal tool within an academic report required careful justification, focusing on its function as a modern, connective platform that aligns with agile principles.

¹ Devxhub (2023). *Tips and Tricks for Efficient Project Management with Discord*. Medium. Available at: <https://devxhub.medium.com/tips-and-tricks-for-efficient-project-management-with-discord-38a6a8c34589>

Reflecting on the process, a key strength was helping establish the projects initial framework. Following with agreements to work with Scrum and Discord in the first meeting provided a working path. However, a personal weakness became apparent when the team, through a slight miscommunication in the third meeting, I hesitated to step in due to an initial social disposition of adapting to a new group of people I hadn't collaborated with before. This was a mistake, but a learned lesson that constant feedback is required. This was overcome as the entire team, myself included developed a habit of being more active and communication, which helped break down any initial social walls.

How Our Team Worked

Our projects progress was steady and set by six meetings. As the person tasked with the methodology section, we considered different approaches. The Spiral model was discussed for its strong risk assessment approach, but we concluded that for a project of this scale, the overhead wasn't necessary. When proposing the core Scrum framework, which everyone agreed was a better fit and we also decided to use Discord for communication. By our second meeting, I presented my report justification for Scrum, and the team officially adopted the plan.

Things were going smoothly until the third meeting, when we noticed a slight miscommunication. This represented a "storming" phase, where different interpretations could have led to conflict. So, in our fourth meeting, I suggested we take a clarification session. We just talked through everything until we were all on the same page. This was a required step to keep us on track. The last two meetings were about bringing everything together. We reviewed the combined report to check for consistency, and I made sure the other sections still lined up with the methodology. Our final meeting was as a simple proofread before we submitted the assignments.²

The slight conflict which became apparent through members working on "System Capabilities" had a slightly different understanding of the user stories than the member working on "Testing". The issue was managed by the clarification meeting which underlined requirements one by one until everyone was in the same page. Efficiently managed which highlighted the importance of clear feedback, additionally synergising our planning methods.

² Institute Project Management (2022). *The 5 Stages of Team Development*. Institute Project management. Available at: <https://instituteprojectmanagement.com/blog/the-5-stages-of-team-development/>.

What I Learned

This Project taught me that project planning isn't about creating a perfect, static plan. It's an approach adaptive to human error and miscommunications that likely happen within most working teams. Our choice of Scrum proved itself effective. While the Spiral mode's intense focus on risk analysis was ideal, we understood that the agile Scrum nature was suitable for a project of this scale, driven by Industry examples. Methods such as Waterfall which I argued against in my report, due to possible inconsistencies which may have been seen late into our project timetable.

Additionally, I learned that planning is an ongoing process not a document you interactive with once. Our initial plan was just a starting point, effective planning happened through our meetings, especially our feedback sessions. That's the agile approach we inherited through learning the module. Discord wasn't simply a convenient messaging app; it was a support structure between our in-person meetings. It provided efficient feedback and rapid availability even through the team's busy schedules.³

Conclusion

Therefore, this project served as a practical lesson in the gap between planning a process and structuring it. The decision to choose the adaptable Scrum framework was collaboratively acknowledge, not because the plan was "perfect" but because it gave the team the tool to navigate through their sections simultaneously, unplanned moments such as the slight miscommunication were managed through efficient feedback. On a personal level, the project highlighted the interest in teamwork, as the initial role of "methodology justification" turned to be that individual roles require constant wider communicative approaches. Moving forward, the adaptive mindset supports the flexible requirement of managing digital technologies.

³ Team, T.S. (2024). *Improving project collaboration with Discord and Statsig*. Statsig.com. Available at: <https://www.statsig.com/perspectives/improving-project-collaboration-with-discord-and-statsig>.

Meeting Notes

Meeting 1:

Date Friday 10th October 2025, 30-40 minutes

Reviewed the coursework specification and confirmed who would be taking which section.

George: Domain Analysis, Guilherme: Methodology, Guido: Capabilities, Ethan: Social, legal implications, Grace: Testing

Meeting 2:

Date Tuesday 14th October 2025, 30-40 minutes

Presented researched, agreed to adopt the Agile Scrum framework as our methodology to ensure a consistent and structured report.

Meeting 3:

Date Friday 17th October 2025, 30-40 minutes

Exchanged and reviewed first drafts, providing feedback. Identified that the “Testing” and “System capabilities” sections needed to be more linked to Scrum framework.

Meeting 4:

Tuesday 21st October 2025, 30-40 minutes

Final review of all 500-word reports. Agreed on referencing style for the structure and submission.

Meeting 5:

Friday 24th October 2025, 30-40 minutes

Proofreading of group Submission report, 500 words were agreed as Submission ready from all members.

Meeting 6:

Thursday, 30th October 2025, 30-40 minutes

Walkthrough of requirements for the individual task (1000 words).

Final report structure submitted together through an in-person meeting.

1. Introduction

The selection of a development methodology is a strategy decision which shouldn't be overlooked due to workflow and risk profiles. For a new commercial website, the traditional, linear Waterfall¹ model with its strong, organised phases, is highly suited to the market. However, the Agile philosophy, which prioritises interactive development and adaptability may offer a more resilient approach. Therefore, this report will adopt the Agile principles, implemented through the structured **Scrum framework**. The process will be focused on communication platform. Using Slack as a prime example of a "Digital principle" that directly facilitates Scrum agility and adaptation.

2. Justification for Agile Methodology

The traditional Waterfall methodology is unstructured for this project due to its inflexible structure. In this model, each phase must be completed before the next phase begins, making late-stage changes likely expensive and time-consuming. This inflexibility creates a significant risk of delivering a product that is misaligned with the dynamic market needs. As stated, the Agile methodology, implemented via Scrum framework, is designed to align with change.² The project is broken into short, cycles known as "sprints", at the end of which a functional piece of the website is delivered. This process enables continuous feedback, ensuring the final product consistently aligns with its goals and allows the team to adapt to new information, the Scrum-framework lowers risk and ensures the delivery of a valuable, market-ready product.³

¹ Johnivan, J.R. (2024). *Agile vs. Waterfall | Software Development Methodologies*. Project-Management.com. Available at: <https://project-management.com/agile-vs-waterfall/>.

² ProductPlan (2023). *Agile vs. Waterfall | Pros, Cons, and Key Differences*. www.productplan.com. Available at: <https://www.productplan.com/learn/agile-vs-waterfall/>.

³ Adobe Communications Team (2022). *Agile vs. Waterfall — from software development to project management*. Adobe.com. Available at: <https://business.adobe.com/blog/basics/agile-vs-waterfall-project-management>

3. The Role of the Collaboration platform

The principle of Agile and Scrum are best realised within a digital environment designed for rapid, transparent communication. Therefore, the team's process will be built through a communicative website, exemplified by Slack⁴, which serves as the project's central idea. This approach is not for convenience; it is a strategic choice to enhance the methodology's effectiveness. Dedicated channels will be created for specific sprints and discussions, ensuring all communications is organised and effective. Importantly, the platform's ability to integrate with core development tools like Jira and GitHub will provide real-time visibility into project progress, from backlog redrafts to code deployment, directly within the team's conversational workflow.⁵ This approach reduces conflict and supports continuous, often needed collaboration for a high performing Scrum team with communication platforms.

4. Conclusion

Therefore, the team will adopt the Agile methodology specifically using the Scrum framework, to ensure the adaptive and responsive development process. This methodology enables collaborative workflow, such as speed and flexibility to complete requirements while maintaining a transparent and possibly lowering risk of costly late-stage changes. The integrative process ensures task delivery. Importantly, this modern process operates within a secure framework, addressing the projects social, legal, and ethical considerations from the beginning.

⁴ Slack (2025). *Best Team Management Software for 2025: Top 12 Tools* | Slack. Slack. Available at: <https://slack.com/intl/en-gb/blog/collaboration/best-team-management-software-for-2025-top-12-solutions>

⁵ Slack (2025). *Agile Planning: Optimize Your Team's Workflow with Proven Agile Techniques* | Slack. Slack. Available at: <https://slack.com/intl/en-gb/blog/collaboration/agile-planning-build-better-workflows-with-this-proven-system>